CORSA Jakarta: Market Entry, Business Case & 90-Day Execution Roadmap

HSG Capstone Project Scope:

Build the strategic and financial foundation for CORSA's first international flagship in Jakarta.

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1. Project Background

CORSA is a young food and lifestyle brand born in Zurich. It combines Italian racing heritage, healthy Mediterranean food, specialty coffee, functional drinks, performance culture and community into one scalable brand system.

The brand is not positioned as a traditional café or restaurant. CORSA is built as a lifestyle-driven food concept for people who move — physically, professionally and culturally. Its core promise is simple: food and coffee as fuel, wrapped in a strong emotional and visual world.

The first CORSA pop-up at Zurich HB served as the first real-market validation of the concept. CORSA was operated in a high-frequency, highly competitive location and generated practical learnings across product, pricing, customer behaviour, staffing, operations, branding and daily execution. The existing company materials position CORSA as "a next-generation food and lifestyle brand designed for people who move," combining pasta, specialty coffee and functional drinks into one scalable system.

The Zurich pop-up also delivered clear early traction: over 200,000 people reached, a 4.9-star Google rating and ROI reached after a three-month pop-up at Zurich HB. These proof points are important because the Capstone Project should not treat CORSA as an abstract idea, but as an operating early-stage brand preparing its next strategic location.

The next intended step is Jakarta, Indonesia, as CORSA's first international flagship location.

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2. Why Jakarta

Jakarta is the selected strategic direction, but the underlying assumptions must be tested.

The project should therefore not answer whether CORSA should generally internationalize. The international ambition is already part of the company direction. Jakarta is the current strategic focus because of its scale, young urban population, growing middle class, high eating frequency, rising café culture, increasing interest in fitness and performance lifestyles, and its potential as a gateway market in Southeast Asia.

The existing Jakarta material frames the city as "the pulse of a nation in constant motion" and describes it as a fast-paced metropolitan hub where tradition meets modernity. The same material defines Jakarta's market characteristics as young, urban and social, with high eating frequency, café culture as lifestyle, and a rising interest in fitness, performance and community.

However, choosing Jakarta as the strategic direction does not mean that all assumptions are correct. The Capstone Project should help CORSA understand which assumptions are strong, which are weak, which need adaptation, and which require further local validation.

Relevant assumptions include:

- whether CORSA's target customers exist in sufficient concentration;
- whether pricing can work in the local market;
- whether the product mix needs adaptation;
- whether the brand identity transfers culturally;
- whether location economics support profitability;
- whether the investment frame is realistic;
- whether the first flagship should be street-facing, mall-based or hybrid;
- whether community and ambassador-led growth can become a real advantage.

Jakarta should be compared briefly with Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong as benchmark markets. These cities should not be treated as equal strategic alternatives in the project. They should serve as reference points to sharpen the Jakarta logic and identify what makes Jakarta attractive, different or risky.

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3. Objective of the Capstone Project

The objective of the HSG Capstone Project is to create a focused, realistic and execution-oriented basis for CORSA's Jakarta market entry.

The central project question is:

How can CORSA enter Jakarta as its first international flagship location in a commercially realistic, strategically coherent and culturally relevant way?

The project should focus on three main pillars:

1. **Strategic Fit, including Competitor & Benchmark Map**
2. **Jakarta Financial Model & Business Case**
3. **Future Innovation: FOOD TECH & PHYSICAL AI**

The financial model and business case should be treated as the core deliverable. The strategic and cultural fit analysis should provide the logic behind the business case, while the 90-day roadmap should translate the findings into concrete next steps for CORSA after the project.

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4. Scope Clarification: What HSG Should Do vs. What CORSA Will Do

To avoid an overly broad project, the Capstone scope must clearly separate what is expected from the students and what remains the responsibility of CORSA.

The students are not expected to build the entire international business from scratch. They are expected to help CORSA structure, test, calculate and improve the Jakarta entry logic.

HSG / Student Scope

The HSG team should focus on:

- market and competitor research;
- benchmark analysis, including Oakberry as a mandatory but not dominant case study;
- strategic fit assessment for Jakarta;
- cultural fit assessment based on available evidence, interviews, proxies and benchmarks;
- location logic and location economics;
- Jakarta-specific financial modelling;
- assumptions testing;
- preparation and execution of selected interviews;
- preparation of questions for local experts and contacts;
- synthesis of risks, open questions and validation needs;
- creation of a 90-day roadmap for CORSA after project completion.

CORSA Internal Scope

CORSA will remain responsible for:

- final strategic decisions;

- investor conversations and negotiations;
- activating existing Jakarta contacts;
- direct business development with families, investors, actors, brokers, landlords, gastronomy entrepreneurs and local partners;
- final brand, design and product decisions;
- operational implementation;
- legal setup;
- location negotiations;
- Jakarta travel and on-site execution;
- final investor deck refinement and fundraising activities.

Shared Interface

The following elements should be developed collaboratively:

- key assumptions list;
- interview questions;
- financial assumptions;
- location criteria;
- validation priorities;
- interpretation of findings;
- prioritization of next steps.

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5. Available Inputs from CORSA

CORSA can provide the students with relevant internal information and documentation.

Available inputs include:

- Zurich pop-up learnings;
- pop-up revenue and cost information;
- product performance insights;
- menu logic;
- pricing logic;
- operational learnings;
- brand identity and visual world;
- existing CORSA strategy materials;
- existing Jakarta concept material;
- existing CORSA GP community concept;
- existing investor and expansion assumptions;
- access to selected Jakarta-related contacts where appropriate.

The current investment assumption for Jakarta is approximately **CHF 200,000**. This should be treated as a working assumption that needs to be tested through the business case.

Existing Jakarta access includes certain families, two investors and well-known actors. Direct real estate or gastronomy entrepreneur contacts are not yet secured, but network access can be requested once the project has clarified the right strategic direction and contact priorities.

The students may speak with selected Jakarta contacts if CORSA releases those contacts during the project. Outreach does not need to be sent independently without alignment. The main task is to prepare the logic, questions and structure so that outreach can be effective and targeted.

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6. Project Pillar 1: Strategic Fit

Including Competitor & Benchmark Map

The first pillar should answer whether the Jakarta entry logic is strategically sound and how CORSA should position itself in the local market.

This pillar should include both market research and strategic interpretation. It should not remain at the level of generic country facts. It should help CORSA understand how Jakarta's consumer behaviour, urban lifestyle, food culture, café culture and premium lifestyle market relate to CORSA's concept.

Key Questions

- Who are the most relevant CORSA customers in Jakarta?
- How strong is the fit with young urban professionals, upper-middle-class consumers, fitness communities, creators, students, expats and lifestyle-driven consumers?
- How do people in Jakarta use cafés and food spaces socially?
- What role do premium cafés, healthy food, coffee, social spaces and community-driven brands play in Jakarta?
- Which competitors or comparable concepts already exist?
- What can CORSA learn from local and international benchmarks?
- How does Jakarta compare briefly to Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong?
- Which cultural assumptions need to be tested before execution?
- Which parts of CORSA's concept are likely to transfer well?
- Which parts may need adaptation?

Cultural Fit

Cultural fit is important, but it is difficult to fully validate remotely. The students should therefore not be expected to prove cultural fit with absolute certainty.

Instead, they should build a structured cultural fit assessment based on:

- desk research;
- benchmark cases;

- selected interviews if feasible;
- local expert input if accessible;
- Jakarta consumer proxies;
- creator and community behaviour;
- local food and café habits;
- comparison with other international food and lifestyle brands.

If possible, at least one person with Jakarta or Indonesia knowledge should be involved through an interview, expert conversation or informal validation session.

Benchmarking

Oakberry should be included as a mandatory benchmark, but it should not dominate the project.

Oakberry is relevant because it shows how a simple product system, strong health positioning, strong visual identity and international expansion logic can be combined. The students should analyse what CORSA can learn from Oakberry's growth model, but also where CORSA should not copy it blindly.

Relevant benchmark questions:

- What made Oakberry scalable?
- How did Oakberry simplify the product?
- How did the brand translate internationally?
- What role did health, lifestyle and convenience play?
- What mistakes or risks should CORSA avoid?
- How does CORSA differ through Italian heritage, pasta, coffee, functional drinks and community?

Other benchmarks can include premium cafés, healthy food brands, functional food concepts, specialty coffee chains, lifestyle restaurants and community-led brands in Jakarta or comparable cities.

Expected Output

This pillar should result in:

- strategic fit assessment for Jakarta;
- competitor and benchmark map;
- target customer overview;
- cultural fit considerations;
- brief comparison with Singapore, Dubai and Hong Kong;
- clear strategic implications for CORSA.

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7. Project Pillar 2: Jakarta Financial Model & Business Case

This is the core deliverable of the Capstone Project.

The purpose is to build a realistic, Jakarta-specific financial model that helps CORSA understand whether the first flagship can work commercially and under which assumptions.

The current investment frame is approximately CHF 200,000. The students should test whether this is realistic and how the investment would need to be allocated.

Key Questions

- What is the realistic investment requirement for a first CORSA flagship in Jakarta?
- Is CHF 200,000 foundercapital enough?
- Does the bank have to be involved?
- What are the main CAPEX blocks?
- What are the expected monthly operating costs?
- What rent levels are realistic for relevant districts?
- What staff structure is required?
- What salary assumptions should be used?
- What food cost and gross margin assumptions are realistic?
- What pricing could work in Jakarta?
- What daily revenue is needed to break even?
- What payback period is realistic?
- What does the business case look like in conservative, base and optimistic scenarios?
- What are the biggest financial risks?
- Which assumptions are most sensitive?

CAPEX Components to Consider

- store build-out;
- kitchen equipment;
- coffee equipment;
- interior and furniture;
- branding and signage;
- POS and technology;
- pre-opening marketing;
- legal and administrative setup;
- licenses and permits;
- staff training;
- opening inventory;
- working capital;
- contingency reserve.

OPEX Components to Consider

- rent;
- salaries;
- food cost;
- coffee cost;
- drinks and ingredients;
- packaging;
- utilities;
- maintenance;
- delivery platform fees if relevant;
- marketing;
- local management;
- accounting and administration;
- insurance;
- waste and logistics;
- miscellaneous operating costs.

Revenue Components to Consider

- pasta;
- coffee;
- functional drinks;
- breakfast or snack products;
- add-ons;
- retail products;
- events;
- B2B partnerships;
- future merchandise potential.

Location Economics

The existing Jakarta concept identifies the following target areas:

Tier 1:

- SCBD;
- Senopati;
- Kuningan.

Tier 2:

- Kemang;
- PIK.

The existing location direction is a flagship with presence and energy, approximately 120–180 sqm, ground floor, street visibility and a sit-down plus take-away setup.

The financial model should connect directly to location assumptions. Rent, footfall, ticket size, customer profile and operating format must be analysed together.

Expected Output

This pillar should result in:

- Jakarta financial model;
- CAPEX and OPEX breakdown;
- revenue model;
- pricing assumptions;
- gross margin assumptions;
- break-even analysis;
- payback logic;
- conservative / base / optimistic scenario;
- key sensitivity analysis;
- location economics overview.

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8. Project Pillar 3: 90-Day Validation & Execution Roadmap

The third pillar should translate the findings into a practical action plan for CORSA after the Capstone Project ends.

The students are not expected to execute the full Jakarta entry. However, they should help CORSA understand what needs to happen next and in which order.

Key Questions

- What should CORSA do in the first 90 days after the Capstone Project?
- Which assumptions need to be validated first?
- Which local experts should be contacted?
- Which broker, investor, ambassador, community or brand categories should be prioritized?
- What should the Jakarta trip focus on?
- Which meetings should be prepared?
- Which financial assumptions need on-site confirmation?
- Which location questions need local validation?
- Which decisions should be made before committing to a location?
- Which open risks remain?

Roadmap Areas

The 90-day roadmap should include:

- validation priorities;
- local expert interviews;
- broker and real estate preparation;

- investor meeting preparation;
- ambassador and community mapping;
- possible brand or supplier conversations;
- Jakarta travel structure;
- location visit criteria;
- next financial data needed;
- decision points;
- risk controls.

Community and CORSA GP

CORSA GP should be included only as a future community engine, not as a main execution task for the Capstone Project.

The existing CORSA GP concept connects Formula 1-inspired running with community, competition and sponsors. It is designed as a night event focused on team spirit, innovation and emotion. It also aims to strengthen community building, create a platform for sponsors and sport brands, establish a recurring signature event and build emotional connection between sport, lifestyle and the CORSA brand.

For the Jakarta project, CORSA GP should be understood as a potential future layer that supports brand building and community retention. It does not need to be planned in full detail within this Capstone scope.

Expected Output

This pillar should result in:

- 90-day validation roadmap;
- prioritized action plan;
- recommended Jakarta trip agenda;
- meeting categories;
- contact categories;
- key open questions;
- next-step decision framework.

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9. Final Deliverables

To keep the project focused, the final output should consist of four integrated deliverables.

1. Integrated Jakarta Market Entry Recommendation

This is the main report or deck. It should answer the core strategic question and include the most important insights from strategic fit, market logic, cultural fit, competitors, benchmarks and location logic.

2. Jakarta Business Case

This includes the financial model, investment logic, operating assumptions, pricing assumptions, location economics, scenarios, break-even and payback.

This is the core deliverable.

3. Evidence & Validation Appendix

This includes sources, benchmark notes, interview summaries, assumptions, open risks, uncertainty levels and data gaps.

The purpose is to distinguish clearly between what is known, what is estimated and what still needs to be validated.

4. 90-Day Validation & Execution Roadmap

This translates the work into concrete next steps for CORSA after the Capstone Project.

It should show what CORSA should do next, which contacts to activate, which meetings to prepare, which assumptions to test and which decisions to make before execution.

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10. Working Principles

Focus Over Breadth

The project should go deeper into a few important questions rather than touch too many topics superficially.

Assumptions Must Be Tested

Jakarta is the selected strategic direction, but the assumptions behind Jakarta must be tested.

Core Brand Identity Is Non-Negotiable

CORSA's core identity should remain protected.

Non-negotiable elements include:

- Italian lifestyle;
- healthy Mediterranean food;
- specialty coffee;
- functional drinks;
- performance culture;
- community-first thinking;

- strong visual world;
- premium but accessible positioning;
- CORSA as a lifestyle system, not an ordinary café.

Market Entry Assumptions Are Adaptable

The following elements may be adapted:

- menu details;
- pricing;
- store size;
- location type;
- day/night balance;
- launch sequence;
- local collaborations;
- communication nuances;
- ambassador approach;
- community activation.

Learning Cycles Must Be Fast

The project should move through quick learning cycles. Speed matters in how quickly assumptions are tested and improved.

Execution Must Be Disciplined

The final recommendation should not simply be creative or optimistic. It must be commercially disciplined and grounded in evidence, benchmarks and transparent assumptions.

Reality Over Theory

The students should connect their work to real numbers, real consumer behaviour, real location economics and real execution constraints wherever possible.

Where real data is unavailable, they should use proxies, benchmarks and assumptions — but clearly label them as such.

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11. Suggested Timeline

Early September

Kick-off, introduction to CORSA, Zurich pop-up insights, brand identity, Jakarta direction and project expectations.

September

Strategic fit, competitor research, benchmark mapping, customer and cultural fit assessment.

October

Financial model, CAPEX / OPEX assumptions, pricing logic, location economics and scenario building.

November

Validation appendix, interview input, refinement of assumptions, roadmap development.

Early December

Final synthesis, recommendation, business case and execution roadmap.

Mid-December

Final presentation and handover.

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12. Success Definition

The Capstone Project is successful if CORSA has, by mid-December, a focused and realistic basis for the next stage of execution.

Success means that CORSA can answer:

- Why Jakarta?
- Which assumptions are strong?
- Which assumptions remain uncertain?
- Which target customers matter most?
- Which competitors and benchmarks are relevant?
- Which location logic should guide the search?
- Is CHF 200,000 a realistic investment frame?
- What revenue level is needed?
- What cost structure is expected?

- What pricing could work?
- What are the biggest risks?
- What should CORSA validate in the next 90 days?
- How should the Jakarta trip be prepared?
- Which contacts should be activated first?

The project is not expected to deliver a fully executed market entry. It should deliver a strong enough strategic and financial basis for CORSA to move into the next execution phase with greater clarity, discipline and confidence.

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13. Closing Statement

CORSA enters this Capstone Project as a young but already operating brand. The first Zurich pop-up has shown that the product, brand and operating concept can create traction.

The next step is not to dream bigger without structure. The next step is to translate ambition into a disciplined market entry logic for Jakarta.

Jakarta is the selected direction. The task now is to test the assumptions, sharpen the business case, understand the market reality and define the next 90 days of execution.

The goal is clear:

Build the strategic and financial foundation for CORSA's first international flagship in Jakarta.